

Safe Automatic Litter Box Guide — Action Checklist

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RESEARCH BEFORE BUYING

- ❑ **Confirm Rotation Axis Type:** Identify whether the automatic litter box uses X-axis or Y-axis rotation before purchasing, because Y-axis rotating drums have been directly linked to cat deaths in documented incidents including the 2025 PetPivot lawsuit.
- ❑ **Verify Sensor Failure Rate:** Request or research the documented sensor failure rate for any automatic litter box you're considering, because APPA 2025 data shows 35% of users experience sensor malfunctions within the first year.
- ❑ **Check for Lawsuits and Incidents:** Search for any product liability lawsuits or documented injury incidents connected to the specific brand and model you're considering, because manufacturers rarely disclose this information in their listings.
- ❑ **Confirm Weight Detection Range:** Verify that the automatic litter box's weight sensor can detect cats as small as 5 pounds or lighter, because weight threshold failures that miss small or senior cats are a documented recurring hazard.

EVALUATE PRODUCT DESIGN

- ❑ **Inspect Entry Mechanism:** Examine whether the automatic litter box has fixed plastic doors or entry tunnels, because these create pinch points that can trap a cat's collar, limb, or tail during operation.
- ❑ **Review Safety Documentation:** Request and carefully read the manufacturer's safety documentation and emergency shut-off procedures before installation, because knowing how to stop the device quickly could save your cat's life.
- ❑ **Confirm Emergency Shut-off:** Verify that the automatic litter box has a visible, accessible emergency stop button or manual override that allows you to immediately halt the cleaning cycle if your cat becomes trapped.
- ❑ **Assess Exit Path Design:** Confirm that the device's design leaves a clear, unobstructed exit path even during an active cleaning cycle, so your cat cannot become trapped in a corner or enclosed space.

MONITOR AFTER INSTALLATION

- ☐ **Test Sensor Response:** Conduct regular sensor response tests by placing your cat near the entrance to verify the device pauses its cycle, because intermittent sensor failures can develop without warning and are impossible to detect without active testing.
 - ☐ **Watch for Behavioral Changes:** Monitor your cat closely for any signs of fear, hesitation, or avoidance behavior around the automatic litter box, because cats may sense sensor or mechanical failures that you cannot see.
 - ☐ **Register for Recalls:** Register your automatic litter box with the manufacturer to receive safety recall notifications, because sensor failures and mechanical defects discovered after purchase are typically communicated only to registered owners.
 - ☐ **Schedule Sensor Calibration:** Follow the manufacturer's recommended sensor calibration schedule to maintain reliable detection performance, because sensors can drift out of proper alignment over time and become unreliable.
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